

Everyone Else • 02/39 • Bilal

The Voice They Could Not Buy. Bilal called the adhan for the Prophet. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

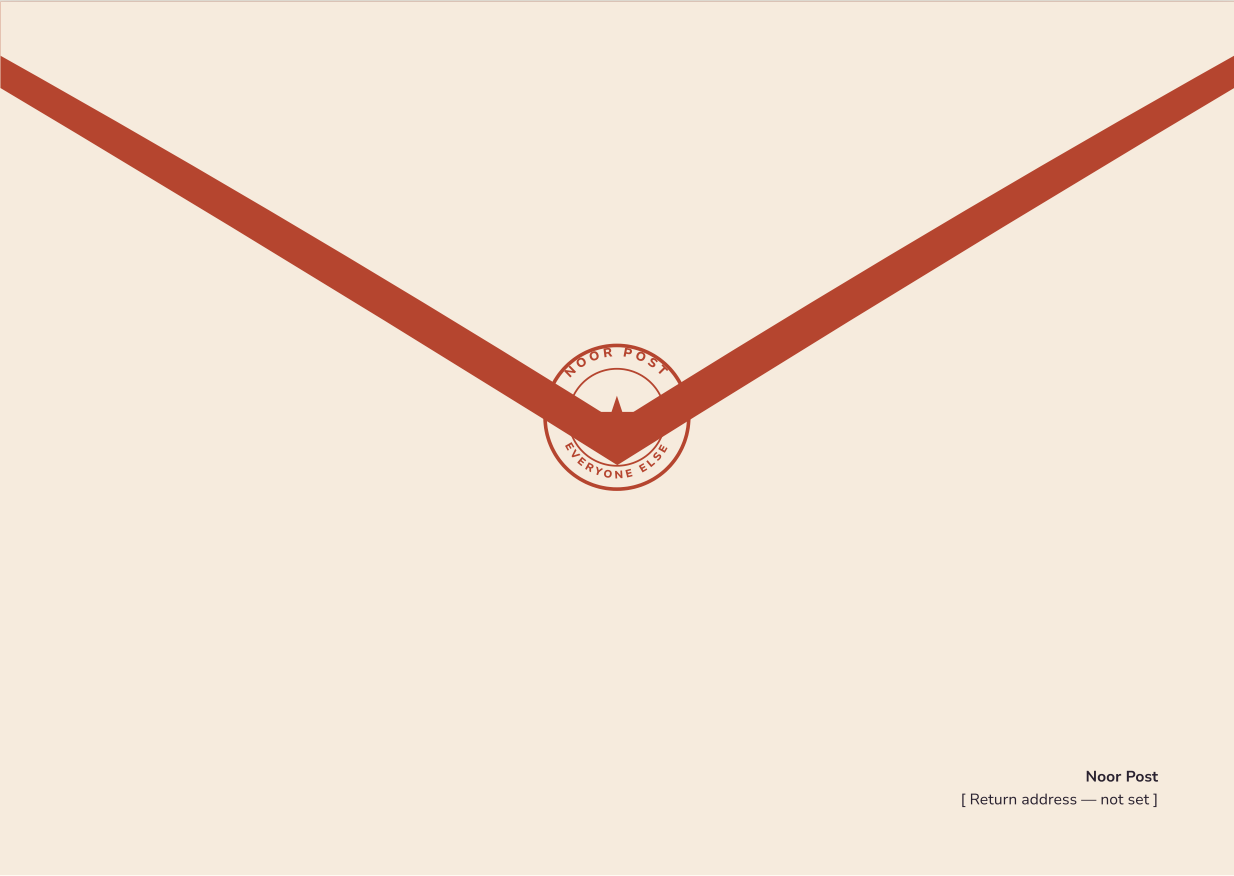
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Bilal called the adhan for
the Prophet.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE • BILAL •
INSIDE THE FLAP

Open together.

• is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, • and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

Bilal

- **Where he came from.** Makkah, born into slavery. His mother's family came from Abyssinia — modern Ethiopia — and he was not counted as belonging to any of the clans that ran the city.
 - **What happened to him.** He was held out and pressured to give up what he had accepted, and he refused. *The single word he repeated is recorded, and is the reason his name survived at all.*
 - **How he was freed.** Bought and released by Abu Bakr. **Freedom in that city had a price and somebody paid it in cash** — this is not a story about a change of heart.
 - **What he did.** He was chosen as the first to call the adhan. In a city organised entirely around whose family you belonged to, the community's public voice was given to a man who had been property.
 - **Afterwards.** He left Medina and lived out his life in Syria, and the accounts say he did not take up the call again.
 - **Why he is in this envelope.** *Bilal called the adhan for the Prophet.*
- He died in Syria, in the years after the Prophet, and is buried there.

The Voice They Could Not Buy



• is the grown-up • ◦ is you • ◦◦ is together

- He was owned by a man in Makkah. That is where this starts, and there is no gentle way to put it — he was somebody's property, he had been born into it, and there was no arrangement by which it was going to end.

◦ Somebody owned him?

- Somebody owned him. And when it came out that he had started believing something his owner had not given him permission to believe, his owner tried to take it back out of him.

◦ How?

- Badly. I am not going to describe it, and you do not need it described. What you need to know is what he said while it was happening, because people who were there remembered it exactly.

◦ What did he say?

- One word. *Ahad*. It means *one*. He said it over and over and would not say anything else.

◦ Just one word?

THE VOICE THEY COULD NOT BUY - CONTINUED

- It was the whole argument. They wanted a different sentence out of him and he gave them one word instead, and they could not get past it.

- Then a man came and bought him, and freed him, and that was that. It cost money. Somebody counted it out, in front of people, and handed it over.

◦ **Was he famous after?**

- Not for the reason you would think. The community needed a way to call people to prayer, and the question was who. Not the loudest. Not the most important family. They picked him, and he climbed up and called it, and that became the sound of the place.

◦ **Why him? Say what you think before I tell you.**

- Nobody can improve on the answer. The people who had owned him and the people who had freed him and everybody else in that city stopped what they were doing when he called, and they all faced the same way, and none of it was about who anyone's father was.

- After the Prophet died he stopped calling it. He tried once, years later, and could not get through the words.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**One word. He never
changed it.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 02/39

THE PROPHET SAID

**“Faith is two halves; one half
is lying in patience and the
other in thankfulness.”**

The Prophet Muhammad

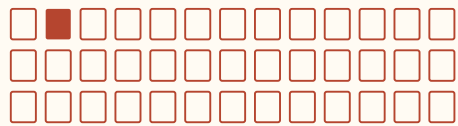


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

Being a believer is half staying patient
when things are hard, and half saying
thank you when they are good.

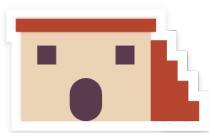
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims of the Prophet, no. 99. Translated by
Badr Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Bilal





**We opened this one
together.**

• _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
